

What is Google Gesture?

A new concept put together by students, not Google, that could help deaf and dumb people communicate with others <http://dgit.in/1LJN7FS>



Rumoured HTC Nexus Tablet

Android Police just posted about HTC Volantis which is an 8.8 inch Nexus tablet and claim it to be legit <http://dgit.in/1uU9VUi>

Fidue A63

Surprisingly detailed

This month we got a whole pile of in-ears from one particular distributor, HiFiNage. Most of these were from the Korean brand T-Peas (the reviews for which you'll see in the upcoming issue), except for one unit which was the Fidue A63. Fidue as it turns out is a Chinese brand that seems to make exclusively in-ears. The audio quality was surprisingly good on the A63. The highs are clear and more pronounced than the rest of the audio spectrum, making them sound quite detailed; almost shrill. You'll notice the sound is very similar to the Klipsch Image S4i, if you've ever got a chance to try those out. There's great detail and dynamic range but the sound lacks body. In contrast the Soundmagic E10M has a more wholesome sound. Hooking it up to the



Price
₹4,550

Asus Xonar Essence STX did help open up the midrange a bit and as far as isolation goes, it's at par with most in-ears like the Cowon EM1.

What about features? Well there's no in-line microphone which might be a problem for some people. The cable isn't the tangle free variety that is becoming quite popular lately. But the one found on the Fidue A63 has Polyurethane sheathing, which feels sturdy and we noticed reduced cord harmonics i.e noise carrying up the cable – a good thing. There seems to be a slight problem with the ergonomics though. While the tips are comfortable and the driver housing is lightweight the housing strangely has sharp edges which do prick you when the headphones move around a little – not at all desirable. If you are someone who likes to experiment with different sound signatures and has a growing collection of in-ears, these might just make a good addition. I wouldn't recommend you look at some other options if you are planning to use them as your primary headphones though.

Siddharth Parwatay



Performance.....70
Features62
Value58
Build56

Specifications

Driver size: 8 mm; Frequency range: 18 - 21,000 Hz; Impedance: 16 Ohm; Max input power: 20 mW; Sensitivity: 101 dB; Cable length: 1.2 m; Accessories included:

Contact

HiFiNage
Phone: 751-2424687
Email: support@hifinage.com
Website: www.hifinage.com
Warranty: 1 year

Audio-Technica ATH-CKX9

A great pair for daily use, if you want to move up from the budget segment

The CKX9 seems built for rough use. The flat tangle free cable, the chunky driver housing, the quality C tips all exude great build quality. And they come with a hardcase that's equally matched. They are large when compared to regular in-ears but despite that are quite comfortable. The varying sizes of C tips (those flexible flanges that nestle within the ear for greater fit) and ear tips really help in getting a good seal.

In terms of performance the ATH-CKX9 falls somewhere in between the two in-ears featured in this time's bazaar. Bass frequencies are enhanced but thankfully are quite accurate. The mid-range



Price
₹4,699

is rendered reasonably well, so is instrument density. The only place they falter a little is the extreme highs – i.e they're not as bright as the SoundMAGICs, which isn't necessarily a failing, just different tuning. Some of our more casual tracks such as *Stereo Love* by Edward Maya (ones that don't demand too much precision) sounded quite good with the enhanced bass. So did live performances; one of our favourite tracks like *The Start Of Something Beautiful* by Porcupine Tree, sounded brilliantly immersive. Purists who look for a neutral (flat response) sound signature will be a tad disappointed with the enhanced bass – it can be distracting. The ATH-CKX9 makes up for its few flaws by its great comfort, isolation and build quality. If you have a bigger budget than most people are willing to invest in in-ear headphones, go for it. Especially if you plan on using in-ears day in and day out.

Siddharth Parwatay



Performance.....74
Features68
Value65
Build75

Specifications

Driver size: 13.5 mm; Maximum Input Power: 20 mW; Frequency Response: 5 - 25,000 Hz; Sensitivity: 104 dB; Impedance: 32 ohms; Weight: 10g; Cable length: 1.2 m; Accessories Included: C tips (S,M,L), Earpieces (XS,S,M,L), Hardcase

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